



SK 2212 Quality of Government in Comparative Perspective

Course Report V22

Course coordinators: Marina Nistotskaya

Organization of the course

SK 2212/GM0727 is a course open to students from the Department of Political Science and Department of Economics at University of Gothenburg, as well as exchange students.

Economics students take the course for 7,5 credits, SK2212 is a 15 credit-course.

There were 23 registered students in spring 2022: 18 for SK2212 and 5 for GM0727. Two students dropped from the course early on. Of the remaining 21 students, 14 passed the course, including all 7,5 credit students and nine 15-credit students.

Up until mid-February 2022 the teaching was conducted remotely on zoom due to university guidelines surrounding the COVID-19 pandemic, followed by on campus teaching thereafter. Remove lecture were conducted on zoom. In addition to this, students communicated with the teachers via Canvas and by email.

The V21 course comprised of ten lectures, seven seminars and individual tutorials. Given the reduction of hours allocated for the course, and the parental leave of Georgios Xezonakis, five seminars were held in one group moderated by Marina Nistotskaya. However, the two seminars related to the final paper were held in two groups, moderated by Marina Nistotskaya and Petrus Olander.

The final seminar is a learning activity, which was carried out for the first time, and, in the assessment of the tutors who mediated the seminar, revealed itself as an important exercise where students practice their skills in presenting complex ideas, creating visual aids and engaging in public discussion. Students enjoyed this learning activity, and this will be kept in the V23 edition of the course.

The course was taught by four instructors: Marina Nistotskaya and Victor Lapuente, who held the majority of lectures, Petrus Olander and Mattias Agerberg. Kohei Suzuki, an associate professor at Leiden University held a special talk on the definition of “quality of government”, which was an important and, even inspirational, input for the students. One of the students, Linnea Quist, is currently working on her MA thesis on a related topic.

Student evaluation

Of 21 students who took the course only six filled in the survey questionnaire (29%). Given a low response rate, this evaluation will not be benchmarked against the previous evaluations. Appendix A reports the results of the student evaluation survey.

Course coordinator reflection

I am generally satisfied how the course ran in V22. There was a good mix of students from different backgrounds (education, personal, etc.), which I encourage the students to build on when engaging with the issues of the quality of government. Seminar group was large, but the usual division of the seminar group into working groups worked well. As always there was a couple of students with particularly keen interest in the QoG issues, who planned

either to write MA thesis on the QoG matters or incorporate the QoG perspective into their theses. Hayden Buker, a SK2212 V22 student, is currently doing his internship at the QoG Institute, and plans to write his MA on the QoG-related matters.

Nine students did not finish the course (all of these took the course for 15 credits). There is a rather high number. The quality of work produced by the students was of good and very standard, as six out of nine SK2212 students who completed the course achieved a pass with distinction.

Forthcoming changes

In November 2022 the director of studies became informed that the Department of Economics decided not to offer the QoG course to their students any longer. I consider this as a loss to the course, as the economics students bring a distinctive professional perspective to the discussion, are also better versed in reading education materials involving statistical analysis, which together contribute to the a more engaging classroom dynamic and learning experience for all involved.

As the number of hours has been considerably decreased for V23, there is a need to keep seminars in one group. There will be personnel changes for V23 iteration of the course, related to Marina Nistotskaya's involvement in a research grant. Although she remains the course coordinator, Victor Lapuente and Georgios Xezonakis will moderate the seminars.

Appendix A. Student evaluation: SK2212 V22

No of registered students: 21

No of respondents: 6

Response rate: 29%

This course enhanced my knowledge of the role of quality of government on human well-being.

A great deal – 4,

To a some degree - 2

How would you evaluate the role of the lectures in getting knowledge about the course's subject?

A great deal – 2,

To a some degree – 3

Not much – 1

How would you evaluate the role of the seminars in getting knowledge about the course's subject?

A great deal – 3,

To a some degree – 2

Not much – 0

Not at all – 1

How would you evaluate the role of the assignments in getting knowledge about the course's subject?

A great deal – 3,

To a some degree – 3

I received useful feedback on the assignments.

Strongly agree – 3

Agree – 2

Disagree –

Strongly disagree – 1

The course developed my ability to read and think critically.

A great deal – 2,

To a some degree – 3

Not much – 0

Not at all – 1

The course improved my ability to evaluate arguments.

A great deal – 3,

To a some degree – 2

Not much – 0

Not at all – 1

The course helped me to be better at arguing the case more effectively.

A great deal – 3,

To a some degree – 2

Not much – 0

Not at all – 1

This class has increased my interest in this field of study.

A great deal – 4,

To a some degree – 1

Not much – 0

Not at all – 1

What is your assessment of the amount of work you have been requested to carry out during the course? Do you consider the course:

Very demanding – 2

OK – 4

Would you say that you had an “eureka moment” during the course, i.e. a time when you suddenly realized something that you previously did not understand or was aware of? If so, please make a short comment about it below.

Yes – 4

No – 2